Tools — Spec Management

Query specification lifecycle state and work through spec task plans.

Tool	Description
`spec_read`	Read a specification by ID.
`spec_list`	List all specifications.
`spec_search`	Search specifications by keyword.
`spec_task_update`	Update a task's status within a spec.
`spec_coverage`	Generate a requirement coverage report.

See `docs/howtos/spec.md` for the full spec workflow.

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spec_read

Read a specification: full `SPEC.md` content, requirements, tasks, and current status.

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description	Typical value
`spec_id`	string	yes	Alphanumeric/hyphen/underscore identifier	`"terse-refactor"`

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spec_list

List all specifications.

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description	Typical value
`status`	enum	no	Filter: `draft`, `in_review`, `approved`, `in_progress`, `implemented`, `verified`, `archived`	`"draft"`

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spec_search

Case-insensitive substring search across spec titles and content (not semantic).

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description
`query`	string	yes	Keyword to find

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spec_task_update

Update a task's status within a spec; mirrors the session task tracker.

Marking a task `completed` writes an RFC 3339 UTC completion stamp into the `PLAN.md` Status cell (`completed (2026-11-08T10:12:00Z)`) without adding a column, so both 6- and 7-column task tables keep parsing. Moving the task to any other status removes the stamp. If the write fails, the tool reports the error rather than the new status.

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description	Typical value
`spec_id`	string	yes	Spec identifier	`"govdoc"`
`task_id`	string	yes	Task within the plan	`"T-001"`
`status`	enum	yes	`pending`, `in_progress`, `completed`, `blocked`	`"completed"`

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spec_coverage

Show which spec requirements are linked to completed tasks; verify coverage before marking a spec complete.

Arguments

Argument	Type	Required	Description
`spec_id`	string	yes	Spec identifier

Example:

```
spec_read spec_id="govdoc"
spec_task_update spec_id="govdoc" task_id="T-014" status="completed"
spec_coverage spec_id="govdoc"
```